



Veteran John

Winter 2025 Newsletter

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We continue to reach out to the community about the needs of some of the most vulnerable people that desperately need the help, love and care from their brothers and sisters.

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Donations

Zelle:

Add a new contact using the email address of bmpveteranjohn@gmail.com

This will connect directing to our ministry account under our sponsor for the 501c Sukkat Shalom assembly. Once you have done this you may go directly to Zelle to make any future donations.

Cash App:

Direct CashApp dontations to **\$veteranjohn**

A direct donation through Sukkat Shalom comes to veteran John Outreach through this church assembly. Just click on donation and **enter your credit card** information and the ministry you are donating to. This is a secure site that has been in operation for a good while.

Don't forget you may also purchase items for this Outreach **through Amazon**.

<https://www.amazon.com/hz/wishlist/ls/1NLIT1XMPXZY7>

Why I Do What I Do



The questions come to me once and awhile such as why do I do what I do. Here is my answer.

After receiving a phone call about one of the men on the street which had been taken to the hospital, I was told he had been taken into emergency surgery, his condition was that of one which had him facing life or death. After being in the emergency room for just a few hours a doctor walked in wearing a mask and scrubs and delivered a message that shocked Dale.

“I need to bring you into surgery right away, other words you will die.”

Dale had been on the streets for nearly 3 years. Distressed from a separation and eventually divorced. Through his distress he walked away from his job and fell into darkness leaving God and everything behind.

Before he fell into decline, he had separated from his wife, then later got back together with her. As his relationship with her

declined further he began drinking and later using drugs to mask the pain. As he quit caring about self, God, and life he found himself homeless.

First, he lost his home, then he ended up living out of his car which he soon lost which placed him on the streets. The enemy kept leading him deeper into the rabbit hole, into the darkness until he couldn't distinguish right from wrong.

The alcohol and drugs had now blinded him even to the point that he could not realize his own condition. After three years of living in a stupor of unawareness he became so sick that he couldn't even walk. After an ambulance was called, he was rushed to John Peter Smith Hospital where he came face to face with reality. As he lay there sick to his stomach, he thought that they would give him medication to help him feel better, but this was not to be the case.

A doctor entered the room in mask and scrubs and delivered a heart shattering reality. We must take you into surgery right away or you will die. These words echoed in his head; he had not even considered death but now he had only one choice, to lose his leg or die. Gangrene had set in and was feeding his body poison.

His body tissue was being eaten away on his feet and one leg, the muscles and organs in these areas were deteriorating. The tissue had been dying and he didn't even realize what was happening because darkness had come to steal and destroy his life.

The messiah has come to us as the light of the world; it is only through him that we can be restored and made new again. The enemy wants to destroy us in darkness by any means necessary.

This seemed to be Dale's last chance as his life now stood in the balance between two words, the choice was his. This was God giving him one last chance to decide between life and death. After the shock of the doctors' words filtered through him, he chose life. Not just physical life but a life with the messiah.

A month later after several surgeries Dale had reached out, he wanted to see me. As I walked into his room at the rehab hospital, I found him with his bible open, and three pages of study notes next to him and a large smile on his face. With one leg missing below the knee and a part of his foot missing from the other leg he only had joy about what had happened.

He began to tell me how losing his leg and foot was what brought him back to God and how he had been in such darkness that he had lost all reality. No longer on drugs or alcohol his face was lit up with brightness that one rarely sees for Dale had been redeemed.

When I meant Dale on the streets, he was living in depressed darkness like so many others. Little did I know that by simply showing up bringing food and sharing the love the father had for him, that such a day like this would come into his life.

I am grateful that I am a part of his life, and I am grateful the Father has called me to be on the streets bringing love and hope. We should never give up on those who might seem hopeless because the God of Abraham, Isaac and Jacob have a purpose for us all through our messiah.

Veteran John

Camping As A Euphemism

In the year I have worked beside Veteran John, I have frequently heard the phrase "camping" or some variation on it. Campers, camping, campsite and so forth, and it causes me to reflect on my childhood.

As a child my parents would load their four kids into a station wagon and takes us out to a national park for a week or so of "roughing" it. My mom would always pack up a cooler of cold cuts for sandwiches or other meals to cook, snacks and beverages. We knew we had meals lined up and guaranteed for each day. Moreover, upon leaving the campground, we knew there were many meals ahead. Though our family wasn't wealthy, we didn't suffer food insecurity (another euphemism for starvation or hunger). We had the security of a roof over our head and the unconditional love of our family members.

It is with no disrespect to the homeless that I say they are not campers. They are not partaking in a weeklong getaway to relax and get away from the city knowing that at the end of the week they will return to their house. They have no idea where their future meals are coming from or whether their "shelter", often a tarp hung over a tree or a box out of the way of foot traffic, is going to survive the next storm. They are in a fight for survival, especially with the extreme heat of the summer and the callous disregard of most people they come across. Their meager encampment will not protect them from the excessive heat, leaving them at risk of death due to hyperthermia in the summer or hypothermia in the winter.

Veteran John believes in the words of Deuteronomy 15:11. He believes that regardless of race, creed or religion that we are to "leave no one behind". Veteran John is committed to helping those on the streets

with vital water during the summer, warm clothes in the winter, meals to help the homeless and supplies to make things just a little easier.

And you can help. Donations made to Veteran John's ministry are tax deductible. He also has an Amazon wish list you can access via our website. You can find both options on the Veteran John website, <https://www.veteranjohn.org> and you can make a difference today.

It Is Now Illegal To Be Homeless



I would first like to recite GOD's words as I start this article. "For the poor will never cease from the land; therefore, I command you saying 'you shall open your hand wide to your brother, to your poor and needy in your land.' Deuteronomy 15:11

The Supreme Court decision (Grants Pass vs Johnson) ruled 6-3 that it is now illegal to be homeless by punishing and imprisoning anyone who sets up a tent, lives in a vehicle, or sleeps in public. This ruling was disguised as an anti-camping ordinance to punish the poor even though there are no shelters to stay in.

The decision allows cities to move more aggressively to clear encampments and arrest those for being homeless by turning them into criminals. That is what we are calling Americans who have lost their means to afford high rents when no other solution presents itself.

This now leaves an estimated 2.5 to 3.5 million people facing an impossible situation. It is easy for someone who has a nice home, job, to judge and rule over the poor who have no voice. Here in Texas the shelters are overflowing. With an estimated 16 percent increase in homelessness over the last couple years I can see now that prisons will overflow because of an individual's economic status.

As believers we cannot sit by and do nothing, that is unless we choose to turn a blind eye. Gods heart is turned towards these who are needing our help. If anyone sits by and does nothing, then they are as guilty as those who have passed laws to destroy others.

Jesus in Matthew chapter 25 makes it very clear who are the sheep and the goats. The sheep are welcome into messiah pastors, the goats who are self-proclaimed believers pass into the abyss. I didn't say this; the messiah himself spoke this.

In the first scripture the Father said to give with an open hand, not a tightly closed hand. What will you do. As for me, I do not sit by and watch, I am out on the streets an average of 100 to 120 days a year in the heat, cold, and rain. Consider this, if you can't join me what will you do to help.

Veteran John

Winter Needs List

SEARCHING CLOSETS AND HOUSE YOU MAY FIND SOME OF THESE ITEMS WE ARE IN NEED OF IN GOOD CONDITION:

100 WARM BLANKETS
100 WARM WINTER GLOVES
SOCKS IN GOOD CONDITION
POTS, PANS TO BE USED OVER CAMPFIRE FOR COOKING.
COOKING UTENSILS SUCH AS SPOONS
TENTS WITH POLES IN GOOD CONDITION

SINGLE MEAL FOOD PACKS FOR 200 MEALS – SINGLE MEAL PACK CONSIST OF THESE OR SIMILAR ITEMS AND CAN BE ORDERED DIRECTLY FROM OUR AMAZON WISH LIST ON OUR WEBSITE OR PLACESS LIKE SAM'S CLUB.

1 MEAT PACK – TUNA SALAD, CHICKEN SALAD OR SOMETHING SIMILAR
1 PACK OF SMALL CRACKERS
1 PROTEIN BAR
1 FRUIT CUP
1 PACKAGE OF PEANUT BUTTER CRACKERS
1 SMALL PACK OF COOKIES
1 SMALL PACKAGE OF CHIPS
3 HARD CANDIES

WATER AND OTHER ITEMS ARE PROVIDED SEPARATELY

MISCELLANEOUS ITEMS

INSTANT INDIVIDUAL COFFEE PACKS - 500
INSTANT HOT CHOCOLATE PACKS - 300
INSTANT HOT APPLE CIDER PACKS - 200
~~SUGAR PACKS / RESTAURANT TYPE 1 CASE~~ **DONATED**
CREAMER PACKS - 500
BOTTLED WATER - 800 PER MONTH (SAM'S CLUB 40 CT. \$4.00
TOILET PAPER

FIND THESE AND OTHER ITEMS ON OUR AMAZON WISH LIST

WINTER COLD KITS/MEDICAL PACKS

~~100~~ PACKAGES OF COUGH DROPS (WALMART STORE BRAND) **30 DONATED** - 70 NEEDED
TYLENOL SINGLES USE PACKS 50 CT. - TOTAL 600 PACKAGES – FOR FEVERS ETC.
BAND-AIDS 1X 3 - 1500 CT.
TRIPLE ANTIBIOTIC OINTMENT (144) CT. - 4 BOXES
DISINFECTANT ALCOHOL PADS

OTHER NEEDS

ZERO DEGREE SLEEPING BAGS 50 + BULK \$75.00 FOR 6 – SEE AMAZON LIST

DOUBLE-LINED BEANIES EXTRA WARM FOR COLD WEATHER BULK 120 CT. FOR \$125.99

AMAZON **\$60.00 DONATED TOWARDS PURCHASE**

HAND WARMERS 500 PAIR ESTIMATED COST \$500.00 (THAT IS .50 EACH.

TENTS 8 X 10 OR 10 X 10 SIZE FOR WINTER WEATHER AGAINST STORMS

8OZ. COFFEE CUPS 400 QTY.

AIR POT FOR SERVING HOT DRINKS ON THE STREETS **ALREADY DONATED**

MANY ITEMS ARE ON AMAZON – YOU CAN MAKE PURCHASES THAT WILL BE DIRECTLY SENT TO US ON OUR WISH LIST.

Simply go to our Web page ([www. Veteranjohn.org](http://www.Veteranjohn.org)) and click on (Amazon list) and it will take you directly to our wish list.

To make donations by Debt or Credit card to Veteran John Outreach simply click on Donations. Our 501c sponsor will transfer all donations to this ministry.

If you wish to donate through Zelle **Type in our email address – bmpveteranjohn@gmail.com and it will bring you to our account through our sponsor Sukkat Shalom whom I wish to thank for their support and help.**

If you should have any questions, please text or call and we shall be pleased to speak with you.

Thank you for your support

VETERAN JOHN

Donations, no matter how small, help. Please consider becoming a monthly donor.

Recognizing Some Of Our Contributors With A Grateful Heart

Please consider joining these others with your generous donations:

Men's Bible Study Group of Midlothian; Haven of Rest Ministries of Burleson; Meadowridge Church; Sukkat Shalom Congregational Fellowship; Rite-Way Roofing; Mooring, Construction + Restoration; Texas Health And Therapy Center – Fort Worth.

Plus, the countless individuals who have donated through their time, finances and food donations.